

BackRub gained a lot of word-of-mouth publicity, there were no takers for the Google service. The first encouragement they received was a \$100,000 (about half a crore) cheque from one of the founders of Sun Microsystems. Commercially, the first breakthrough came when Google was selected by AOL as the search engine for its site. Google's index quickly grew to include 1 billion Web pages by 2000. "Google" is derived from "googol," which refers to a number that has one followed by a hundred zeros.



An early Google search page

1999: Napster... What Else?

March: Melissa Causes Havoc

The Melissa virus infected about a million PCs worldwide. Melissa was a Microsoft Word macro and mass e-mailer virus that appeared as an e-mail with a Word document as attachment. Once opened, it used Microsoft Outlook to mail itself to the first 50 addresses in the address book. It was the first virus capable of jumping from computer to computer on its own. Creator David Smith was tracked down and arrested a week after the virus was first noticed.